

# Infection Prevention & Safe Support Basics

Everyday precautions for community disability support

Suggested training type: Read + mini quiz   Suggested pass mark: 80%   Review/validity: 12 months recommended review cycle

## Learning objectives

- Apply basic infection-prevention habits during routine support.
- Know when hand hygiene and PPE may be needed.
- Avoid attending work when illness creates an unacceptable risk.
- Follow participant-specific plans and organisational procedures.

## 1. Why this matters

Disability support often occurs in homes, vehicles and community settings. Infection prevention protects participants, workers and others, especially people who may be medically vulnerable.

## 2. Core habits

- Perform effective hand hygiene at appropriate times.
- Use gloves or other PPE when the task and risk assessment require it; PPE does not replace hand hygiene.
- Cover coughs and sneezes and follow current respiratory hygiene practices.
- Clean shared equipment according to instructions and organisational procedures.
- Handle waste, laundry and bodily-fluid exposure safely.
- Do not share personal care items between participants.

## 3. When you are unwell

Follow Opus Care's illness and fitness-for-work procedure. Report relevant symptoms or exposure concerns promptly. Do not conceal illness to avoid missing a shift when that could put a participant at risk.

## 4. Participant-specific directions

Some participants have individual infection-control, wound, catheter, respiratory, enteral feeding or other health-related plans. Only perform tasks you are authorised, trained and competent to perform, and follow the specific plan exactly.

## 5. Refresher training

The NDIS Practice Standards for registered providers specifically identify infection-prevention and control training, including refresher training, for workers providing supports. Even as an unregistered provider, Opus Care can use this as a strong workforce safety benchmark.

# Knowledge Check

Choose the best answer for each question. Suggested pass mark: 80%. This quiz checks understanding of the module; it does not replace supervised practical competency where that is required.

1. Does wearing gloves replace hand hygiene?

- A. Yes
- B. No
- C. Only outdoors
- D. Only for short shifts

2. What should a worker do if they are unwell and may pose an infection risk?

- A. Hide symptoms
- B. Follow illness reporting/fitness-for-work procedures
- C. Attend anyway
- D. Ask the participant to decide without telling management

3. Can a worker perform a complex health task just because a participant asks?

- A. Yes
- B. No - only if authorised, trained and competent
- C. Always if family agrees
- D. Only after watching a video

4. Why clean shared equipment?

- A. Only appearance
- B. To reduce infection transmission risk and maintain safe support
- C. It is optional
- D. Only before audits

5. Who benefits from infection prevention?

- A. Participants only
- B. Workers only
- C. Participants, workers and others
- D. Managers only

Manager answer key is included in the accompanying quiz JSON file.

## Source and reference notes

This Opus Care resource is an original internal training summary. It is based on current public guidance and does not reproduce third-party courses. Workers should use the linked official resources where specified.

- <https://www.ndiscommission.gov.au/rules-and-standards/ndis-practice-standards/core-module-provider-governance-and-operational>
- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/your-industry/health-care-and-social-assistance/disability-support>

**Important:** Internal completion does not create a nationally recognised qualification, professional licence, or practical competency. Opus Care should verify external qualifications and practical skills appropriate to each worker's role and the supports actually delivered.